

Voynich Procedural-Structure Hypothesis

Professional reading edition of the evolving public MKUFT canon

Mark Charles McLaughlin

ORCID: [0009-0005-7736-1511](https://orcid.org/0009-0005-7736-1511)

Scientific affiliation	Independent Researcher
Object status	Research module reading edition — not a standalone Zenodo publication
Public source	Open canonical public source
Source commit	26e06b6fea52e6b052dbdd540e80d1d926b96b07
MKUFT backbone DOI	10.5281/zenodo.17780566

Status boundary. This PDF is a reader-facing rendering of an evolving GitHub research module. It is not a frozen standalone paper and does not receive a separate DOI. The cited Git commit fixes the exact source identity of this edition.

Rights. Copyright © 2026 Mark Charles McLaughlin. All rights reserved. Historical licences remain controlling only for their exact frozen objects.

Purpose

This document presents a testable alternative classification of the Voynich Manuscript using the MKUFT / ESRT / ESF method.

It does not claim a translation, proven historical purpose, or established executable function.

The narrower hypothesis is:

Some Voynich layout, repetition, positional structure, and cross-section organisation may be better modelled as procedural or operational structure than as ordinary continuous prose alone.

This hypothesis must compete quantitatively with linguistic, cipher, scribal, decorative, mnemonic, diagrammatic, and null models.

Core position

The manuscript is treated here as an **executable-system candidate**.

The candidate model asks whether position, state-like forms, and flow relations constrain how the artefact is organised. In plain language, some parts may function more like diagrams, indexes, process surfaces, or memory aids in which placement and sequence matter, rather than only as sentences awaiting translation.

Evidence boundary

The public case may use observable layout, position and orientation, repeated forms, block density, line and paragraph structure, cross-page consistency, and perturbation or scrambling tests.

It must not rely on private intuition, hidden keys, retrospective glyph meanings, or an interpretation that cannot be scored by independent raters.

Why test a procedural alternative?

The manuscript has resisted stable consensus translation. That does not prove it is non-linguistic, but it permits competing models to be tested.

A procedural model becomes worth testing where word-like forms show positional dependence, layout roles repeat across pages, illustrations and text blocks form stable spatial relations, variations resemble parameter changes or state markers, and reordering would predictably damage the proposed structure.

These remain hypotheses until quantified against alternatives.

ESRT criteria

Addressing

Does position determine role?

Candidate indicators include rings and sectors, columns and zones, recurring anchors, text blocks with stable spatial roles, and repeated page frames.

State representation

Do recurring forms mark condition, phase, category, or mode?

Candidate indicators include jars or containers, pools, roots and plant parts, repeated token clusters, and stars, wheels, or figures occupying consistent roles.

Flow

Does the artefact show ordered transition, routing, circulation, or sequence?

Candidate indicators include channels, radial progression, branching, repeated line structure, and entry/junction/exit placement.

A manuscript can contain these features without being executable. The classification becomes meaningful only if the combined model makes predictions that alternatives do not.

Working section map

Botanical folios

Candidate interpretation: illustration parts may act as spatial anchors; roots, stems, leaves, and attached text may define recurring positional roles; secondary blocks may mark a separate operation, qualifier, or reference.

Ordinary alternatives include herbal description, mnemonic or emblematic illustration, scribal page convention, invented or composite botany, and decorative layout.

Test: code illustration-relative text positions across botanical folios and compare their stability with matched illustrated manuscripts and shuffled controls.

Circular and zodiac-like folios

Candidate interpretation: rings and angular sectors may form an address space; inner and outer rings may carry different structural roles; repeated sector positions may show comparable density or token classes.

Ordinary alternatives include astronomical or astrological diagrams, calendars, cosmological illustration, decorative ring structure, and conventional label placement.

Test: preregister sector boundaries, code density and token classes, and test cross-wheel repeatability against rotation, shuffling, and comparable medieval diagrams.

Pharmaceutical folios

Candidate interpretation: recurring container classes may mark categories or states; detached plant parts may function as indexed inputs; short text blocks may label components, quantities, or conditions.

Ordinary alternatives include materia medica inventory, apothecary illustration, decorative container taxonomy, and conventional captioning.

Test: blindly classify container shapes and test whether associated text features remain stable within classes better than chance and matched baselines.

Recipe-like folios

Candidate interpretation: dense text may reference components or states defined elsewhere; repeated short forms may occupy stable positions within lines or paragraphs.

Ordinary alternatives include ordinary recipe prose, lists, repeated grammatical particles, and scribal abbreviation.

Test: compare positional recurrence with natural-language, cipher, and generated pseudo-text models.

Balneological folios

Candidate interpretation: pools and channels may form state-and-transition diagrams; figures may occupy carrier, stage, or participant roles; text may cluster at entries, junctions, or exits.

Ordinary alternatives include bathing or medical illustration, symbolic narrative, decorative connection, and conventional caption placement.

Test: code graph structure independently of interpretation and test whether text placement tracks graph roles across folios.

Cross-section hypothesis

A stronger version of the procedural model predicts a complementary sequence: **botanical or material indexing → component or state classification → process instruction → transformation or flow → timing or positional coordination**.

This is not established; it is an integration pattern to be tested.

Test programme

1. Page classification

Use categories defined before detailed scoring, including an uncertain/mixed class.

2. Spatial binning

For rectangular pages, use coarse registered zones. For circular pages, use registered ring and angular divisions, then repeat the analysis under rotated boundaries to test robustness.

3. Block identification

Record folio identifier, position, block length, sequence position, relation to illustration or diagram, and coder confidence.

4. Feature extraction

Measure density, token-class distribution, recurrence, positional mutual information, cross-page role stability, and graph-node relation where applicable.

5. Baseline comparison

Compare with shuffled layouts, rotated circular diagrams, matched medieval manuscripts, natural-language and cipher models, generated pseudo-text, and independent scribal-layout models.

6. Blinded prediction

Train the model on one folio subset and predict held-out page roles, block locations, or cross-section associations. A model that explains pages only after inspection does not pass.

Node / Line / Token grammar

The NLT shorthand is:

- **Node** — positional anchor or address;
- **Line** — candidate transition or routing sequence;
- **Token** — possible parameter, modifier, state flag, word, or other repeated unit.

“Token” remains neutral. It is not declared an operator without comparative evidence.

Candidate practice domains

If procedural structure is supported, possible historical use classes might include medical or physiological regimen, pharmacological or alchemical procedure, calendrical or astrological timing, ritual or mnemonic instruction, training or memory system, or a mixed illustrated compendium.

These are competing use classes rather than conclusions.

Relationship to MKUFT

The Voynich case tests whether complex information can be carried through addressing, state, and flow without relying entirely on ordinary prose.

It is an application branch. A successful informational model would not by itself support MKUFT physical claims.

Claims not made

This document does not claim translation, phonetic decoding, proof that glyphs are operators, certainty about original intent, certainty about one practice domain, a hidden energetic or metaphysical mechanism, or proof that linguistic approaches are impossible.

Predictions

Before held-out analysis, the procedural hypothesis predicts stable positional roles across comparable folios, cross-page recurrence beyond matched baselines, predictable degradation after layout scrambling, section-specific but related structural grammars, and better held-out classification than simpler alternatives.

Falsification

The model is weakened or rejected if positional roles do not replicate; sector or container classifications are unreliable; shuffled or rotated controls perform equally well; linguistic, cipher, scribal, or decorative models explain the data better;

the model cannot predict held-out pages; apparent cross-section links disappear after correction for frequency and layout; or the method depends on assigning meaning after observing the result.

No single failed page rejects every procedural possibility, but repeated failure of the registered primary predictions rejects this model.

Related public documents

- [ESRT / ESF Method Appendix](#)
- [ESRT / ESF and Voynich Support](#)
- [Clear Public MKUFT Explanation](#)
- [Falsification Summary](#)
- [Cross-Support and Traversal Map](#)

Summary

The Voynich procedural model is a serious candidate hypothesis only if it beats ordinary alternatives under blinded, quantitative, held-out tests.

What constraints does the observable structure obey, and which model predicts them best?